Ignacio Lepe

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Tobin Center for Economic Policy, 87 Trumbull St, New Haven, CT 06511
Last update: September 2026

Fields: Labor Economics, Economics of Education, and Market Design.

EDUCATION

Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Chile — **Santiago, Chile**
M.Sc. in Economics — *2023 – 2024*
Grade: 6.2/7.0 (*summa cum laude*)

Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Chile — **Santiago, Chile**
Commercial Engineering, B.Sc. in Economics — *2019 – 2023*
Grade: 6.2/7.0 (*summa cum laude*)
Class rank: 98.2nd percentile of cohort (Circle of Excellence).

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Publications

Education Spending and Economic Growth: Short- and Long-Term Effects in a Global Panel. With Arturo Galindo and Dante Contreras. *Review of Development Economics*, 2026.

Generative Artificial Intelligence in Schools: Institutional Readiness and Digital Competencies in ICILS 2023 (in Spanish). With Christopher Neilson. *Papeles de Economía Española*, Issue 184, FUNCAS, 2025.

Working Papers

Substitute or Complement? Generative AI Use and Student Achievement: Evidence from PISA 2025. With Dante Contreras. Revise and resubmit at *European Economic Review* (Short Communication).

Designing Smart School Choice Recommendations: Heuristics for Sure Alternatives. Master's thesis.

Heterogeneous Effects of Lengthening the School Day on Students' Academic Achievement: A Longitudinal Study of Full Day School Reform in Chile. With Dante Contreras and Ignacio Riveros.

Work in Progress

Segregation and Elite School Exit in Chile: Equilibrium Considerations for Equitable School Admission Systems. With Tamara Muñoz Ojeda and Christopher Neilson.

More than Growth. Redistribution, Demography, and Poverty Reduction in Chile, 1987 to 2017. With Dante Contreras, Joaquín Prieto and Cristian Valenzuela.

Diminishing Returns to Education Spending: Updated Global Evidence and Implications for Latin America and the Caribbean. With Elena Arias, Dante Contreras and Mercedes Mateo-Berganza.

Policy Reports

Extended School Day: Evidence, Implementation, Challenges and Recommendations. With Dante Contreras. Technical note N° IDB-TN-2792, Inter-American Development Bank, 2023.

Cost Analysis: Charging Infrastructure for Electric Vehicles. With Ignacio Rivas and Javier Contador. Technical note ESA, Ministry of Energy, 2022.

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Academic Excellence Scholarship, M.Sc. In Economics. FEN UCh. — 2023 – 2024
Circle of excellence. FEN UCh. (x4) — 2020 – 2024

High School Valedictorian. 2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Yale University **New Haven, CT**
Pre-Doctoral Fellow *January 2026 – Present*
Tobin Center for Economic Policy and Economics Department. Advisor: Prof. Christopher A. Neilson.
Research assistance on:

- "Industrial Organization of Education Markets" (Neilson). Accepted with minor revisions, *Annual Review of Economics*.
- "Making Algorithmic Transparency Meaningful: Evidence from Chile's National School Admissions Platform" (Neilson, Medina & Ortiz). Submitted.
- "The Value of Choice in Centralized School Assignment: Welfare Gains from Acting on Family Preferences in Ecuador" (Elacqua, Jacas, Krussig, Méndez & Neilson). Working paper.
- "Enabling Access to Free Higher Education in Bogotá through Personalized Admission Chances on Atenea" (Neilson & Zárate). Randomized controlled trial, AEA RCT Registry AEARCTR-0018833.

ConsiliumBots **Santiago, Chile**
Data Scientist & RA *July 2024 – January 2026*
Support multicountry RCTs, school choice interventions, and applied research with Prof. Christopher A. Neilson on education, economics, and policy.

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab **Santiago, Chile**
Senior Research Associate *September 2024 – July 2025*
Lead analysis and coordination for education-focused RCTs in Latin America

Pontifical Catholic University of Chile **Santiago, Chile**
Research assistant *April 2024 – November 2024*

- "Evaluation of the School Admission System: Analysis of the algorithm and its effects on school segregation". Authors: María Isidora Palma, Gabriel Gutiérrez, Francisco Lagos & Fernanda Ramírez.

Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Chile **Santiago, Chile**
Research Assistant at UCh and IDB, Professor Dante Contreras *February 2023 – December 2024*

OTHER EXPERIENCE

International CORE Economics **London, England**
Consultant *January 2023 – January 2024*

- The Economy After COVID: Elaboration of chapters, references and applied exercises for undergraduate economics course text. Supervisor: Óscar Landerretche.

Central Bank of Chile **Santiago, Chile**
Intern *January 2023 – February 2023*

- Methodologies and Quantitative Analysis Group, Prospective Analysis and Risk Department, Financial Stability Management. Supervisor: David Coble.

Energy Sustainability Agency, Ministry of Energy **Santiago, Chile**
Intern *July 2022 – December 2022*

- Co-author of "Cost Analysis: Charging Infrastructure for Electric Vehicles in Latin America 2022 version".

LEXEN Constitution 2022 **Santiago, Chile**
Assistant coordinator in the minutes preparation team *July 2021 – August 2022*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate - Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Chile **Santiago, Chile**
Teaching Assistant Macroeconomics II (M.Sc. in Economics) *July 2024 – December 2024*
professors Humberto Martínez & Eugenia Andreasen

Undergraduate - Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Chile **Santiago, Chile**

Teaching Assistant Econometrics I, Professor Valentina Paredes *March 2024 – July 2024*

Teaching Assistant Econometrics I, professors Valentina Paredes & Paola Bordón *March 2023 – July 2023*

Teaching Assistant Macroeconomics III/Trade & Growth, Professor Pablo García *March 2023 – July 2023*

Teaching Assistant Microeconomics III/Labor, Professors Dante Contreras & Esteban Puentes *March 2023 – July 2023*

Teaching Assistant Statistics II, professors Eduardo Engel & Juan Díaz. *July 2021 – December 2021*
July 2022 – December 2022

Teaching Assistant Statistics I, professors Eduardo Engel & Juan Díaz. *March 2021 – July 2021*
March 2022 – July 2022

Teaching Assistant Introduction to Macroeconomics, Professor José de Gregorio. *July 2021 – July 2022*

Teaching Assistant Introduction to Microeconomics, Professor Andrés Gómez-Lobo. *August 2020 – December 2021*

Teaching Assistant Introduction to Microeconomics, Professor Óscar Landerretche. *March 2021 – July 2021*

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

UCh Commercial Engineering Student Council **Santiago, Chile**
Economics Students Delegate *August 2020 – October 2021*

Academic Secretary's Office *August 2020 – October 2021*

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

2026 Pre-Doctoral Economics Conference, Yale University. "Opportunity Costs of Elite Careers and Fertility: Evidence from Admission Cutoffs in Chile" (with Tamara Muñoz), presented by Tamara Muñoz. New Haven, CT. June, 2026.

Workshop on Economics of Education. Keynote speaker: Jesse Rothstein. Valle Nevado, Chile. August, 2025 (Attendee).

IDB Education Meeting – Annual Research Brief (Presenter). IDB Headquarters, Washington D.C, US. October, 2024.

Workshop on Economics of Education. Keynote speaker: Miguel Urquiola. Valle Nevado, Chile. August, 2024 (Attendee).

SKILLS

Programming: Python, STATA, MATLAB, LaTeX, Excel (Advanced), R (Intermediate).

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent).

REFERENCES

Christopher A. Neilson, Professor of Economics and Global Affairs, Yale University and Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research. christopher.neilson@yale.edu

Dante Contreras, Professor in the Department of Economics at the Faculty of Business and Economics, University of Chile, and Deputy Director of the Center for the Study of Conflict and Social Cohesion, COES. dcontrer@fen.uchile.cl